A-A-54009
15 October 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

STERILIZER, SURGICAL INSTRUMENTS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers a small vapor pressure device for sterilizing medical and dental instruments.

Salient characteristics.

General. Shall be a vapor pressure device for sterilizing medical and dental instruments utilizing an alcohol base solution.

Dimensions. The chamber shall be approximately 6 inches in diameter by 11 inches long. The outside dimensions shall be approximately 20 inched long, 13 inches wide and 10 inches high. A large instrument tray, approximately 11 inches long by 6 inches wide, with a detachable handle designed to fit the sterilizing chamber shall be provided.

Construction. The cabinet shall be constructed of corrosion resisting steel and shall have a safety chamber latch to prevent the door from opening when the chamber is pressurized. The cabinet shall be insulated against excessive temperatures. Shall have a self-metering valve which provides the correct amount of sterilizing solution per cycle.

Controls. Controls shall consist of a temperature indicator light, an on-off switch, an automatic timer bell to signal completion of the sterilization cycle, a control knob to activate a self-metering valve, and a gauge to record progress of the sterilization cycle.

AMSC/NA FSC 6530

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Operation. The sterilizer shall operate at 270°F ± 5°F, and 20 to 40 PSI gauge pressure after a 12 minute initial warmup. The sterilizer shall have a reservoir sufficient to contain sterilizing solution for approximately 28 sterilization cycles. Also a self contained exhaust system, a condensate tray for emptying the solution after sterilization cycles, and a pressure relief valve which operates between 40 to 60 pounds pressure.

Electrical. The unit shall operate at 115 volts, 60 Hz and shall have a power rating of 500 Watts. The power cord shall be a 3 conductor cord (with ground lead) approximately 60 inches long, outside the cabinet, terminating in a 3 prong male plug which complies with American National Standards C73.11, and shall meet the requirements of UL 544.

Workmanship. The sterilizer shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One sterilizer, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specified requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more inspection characteristics. The unit of product for inspection purposes shall be one unit of issue, as specified. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for examination shall be conducted at inspection level S-1, AQL of 2.5, and sampling for tests (when applicable) shall be conducted at inspection level of S-1.

Examination. The sterilizer shall be examined for defects including, but not limited to those listed below:

Exposed edges not free of burrs and sharpness.

Finish not free of scratches.

Sterilizer does not rest evenly on flat surface.

Safety valve not marked with discharge pressure valve.

Condensing coil not free of kinks and sharp bends.

Nameplate missing, incomplete or illegible.

Plumbing connections not properly made, not cleanly dressed, not first class workmanship.

Performance tests. Component accuracy testing may be performed at anytime prior to installation on the sterilizer, provided that the test reports are retained and submitted with each sterilizer.

Safety relief valve. The safety relief valve shall be connected to a pressure source. The pressures at which the valve relieves and reseals shall be recorded.

Thermostat. The accuracy of the thermostat shall be determined using equipment accurate to the nearest 0.5^{0}F.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Chamber temperature reading. The chamber temperature shall be measured by means of a thermocouple or maximum reading thermometer at the midpoint of the chamber during a sterilization cycle after the temperature has stabilized.

Dielectric strength. While in a heated condition, following the temperature test, the sterilizer shall be subjected to a gradually increasing potential of 1000 volts at 60 Hz applied between the current carrying parts and the metal closures and maintained at maximum value for one minute.

Hydrostatic Pressure. The pressure cylinder (sterilizing chamber) shall be connected by suitable fittings and tubing to a hydrostatic pressure source. There shall be no leakage or sweating, except around the door, and no permanent set as a result of the hydrostatic pressure (60 psig).

Operation. Each Sterilizer shall be operated in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions to determine compliance with requirements herein. The following actions shall be observed:

Timer switch or separate heater switch, whichever applies, activates heater and indicator light.

Thermostatic air vent allows most air to be evacuated from the chamber.

Door cannot be opened at any pressure in excess of 3 psig, any temperature in excess of 212^0F, whichever applies.

Temperature gage registers.

Temperature switch cycles to maintain temperature and pressure.

Timer deactivates unit at the end of the cycle.

Time to reach 250^0F, and 15 psig, and 270^0F and 27 psig is in compliance with this specification.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specification, standard, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NOTE 1: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6530-00-111-7249	STERILIZER, SURGICAL INSTRUMENTS

NOTE 2: The sterilizer shall be compatible with

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6850-00-148-9776	ALCOHOL BASE SOLUTION

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-2062

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-54009	STERILIZER, SURGICAL INSTRUMENTS

3a NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*.

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge (*DO NOT STAPLE*), and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4968 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEFENSE LOGISTICS AGENCY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RSTE
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:27Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.